

Motorola Edge 40 Neo

Design and display champ, but lacking in performance chops

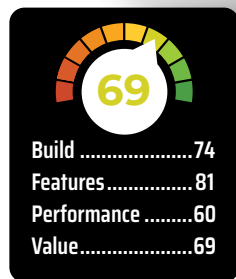
The Motorola Edge 40 Neotakes the essence of what made the Moto Edge 40 a success and tries to emulate that in the lower mid-range space. Priced at ₹23,999, the Moto Edge 40 Neo looks like a solid phone. However, faced with competition from the likes of the iQOO Z7 Pro, Infinix Zero 30 5G, and Realme 11 Pro, is this one worth your hard-earned money? Has it recreated the magic the Edge 40 brought?

BUILD AND DESIGN

The Edge 40 Neo has almost every design characteristic of its more expensive sibling. The phone is slim at just 7.9 mm and is lightweight at merely 170 g. Once again, Motorola has collaborated with Pantone for the colours which include Caneel Bay, Soothing Sea, and Black Beauty. The Motorola Edge 40 Neo is merely 1 g lighter than the Edge 40. Motorola claims that the Edge 40 Neo now dethrones the Edge 40 to become the world's lightest 5G smartphone with IP68 protection.

The Motorola Edge 40 Neo looks punches way above its price range with its comfortable curved edges on the front and back and the vibrant and unusual colours. There are other slim and lightweight phones with leather backs at this price though including the slimmer iQOO Z7 Pro and the new Infinix Zero 30 5G. However, neither comes packing an IP rating, let alone an IP68 rating.

The Edge 40 Neo strips down some build elements to cut costs compared to the Edge 40 though. For instance, the frame is now plastic. The Edge 40 had an aluminium frame, but at under ₹25K, I won't complain. The Edge 40 Neo is also slightly thicker. Regardless, the Moto Edge 40 Neo is one of the best-designed phones under ₹25K with the bonus of IP68 dust and water resistance. Also, you get stereo dual speakers with Dolby



similar 6.55-inch FHD+ pOLED panel with 144 Hz refresh rate and HDR10+ support. But on the Moto Edge 40 Neo, you've also got support for 1 billion colours and higher peak brightness, which is fantastic. Now, the problem I had with the Moto Edge 40 has unfortunately not been solved – Adaptive Refresh Rate mode still only goes up to 120 Hz, so to see 144 Hz in action, you would have to keep it active all the time. This would obviously deplete your battery life. Disappointing.

That aside, this sleek curved screen looks fantastic with great colours, deep blacks, and fantastic viewing angles. There were surprisingly few accidental touches on the edge of the screen – it actually does a pretty decent job at rejecting accidental corner touches. HDR content looks great on YouTube, but sadly, it is not supported on Netflix so far.

Atmos support that sound wonderful.

DISPLAY

Despite being cheaper, you've got a

The display is also really bright. In our tests, I recorded 1280 nits of brightness using a LUX meter on Auto Mode under sunlight, which is brilliant for this price range. So, screen visibility is solid in any condition. Overall, this is a gorgeous curved display with impressive specifications and real-world performance.

PERFORMANCE

The Motorola Edge 40 Neo is the world's first phone to feature the MediaTek Dimensity 7030 SoC. It is actually not anything new though since it is the rebadged version of the Dimensity 1050. Starting off with synthetic benchmarks, I compared the Moto Edge 40 Neo to similarly-priced phones such as the iQOO Z7 Pro, Infinix Zero 30, Tecno Camon 20 Pro, and Realme 11 Pro. Sadly, it came out at the bottom in AnTuTu with a score of 5,22,651. In comparison, the iQOO Z7 Pro blew past it with a score of 7,13,216. I also put it through GeekBench, and the Moto Edge 40 Neo was once again around the bottom of the barrel, especially when it comes to Multi-Core performance.

In PCMark Work though, I got a solid score of 14,512, which means the phone will excel at completing productivity tasks with ease. The phone also shows very low throttling. I ran the CPU Throttling Test for 15 minutes with 20 threads and the phone only throttled to 94 per cent of its peak performance, which is excellent. The phone does heat slightly with heavy workloads, but it does throttle its performance, so it should be smooth most of the time.

I also tested the storage speeds via Androbench and the Moto Edge 40 Neo was outperformed by almost every other phone I tested it against in the same price range. I got only 1003 MB/s Sequential Read Speed and 919 MB/s Sequential Write Speed, which is considerably lower than the Infinix Zero 30, Tecno Camon 20 Pro, and Realme 11 Pro.

To test the GPU, I ran a couple of benchmark tests again, I was disappointed here. In 3D Mark Wild Life Extreme, where most of its competitors scored above 1,000 points, the Moto Edge 40 Neo only clocked in 699 points. In GFXBench, the phone scored almost as